YUHANG SHU

Email: jxd2cf@virginia.edu

EDUCATION

2026, Expected **Ph.D. in Developmental Psychology**
Department of Psychology, University of Virginia, VA, US
Planned Dissertation: *Who is trustworthy? The impact of inequality on children's social trust*
Committee: Drs. Amrisha Vaish (Chair), Vikram K. Jaswal, Jazmin Brown-Iannuzzi, Gabrielle Adams
GPA: 4.0/4.0

2026 **Quantitative Psychology Concentration**
Department of Psychology, University of Virginia, VA, US

2023 **M.A. in Developmental Psychology**
Department of Psychology, University of Virginia, VA, US
Thesis: *The impact of inequality on young children's prosocial behaviors*
Committee: Drs. Amrisha Vaish (Chair), Vikram K. Jaswal
GPA: 4.0/4.0

2020 **M.A. in Human Development**
Department of Human Development, Cornell University, NY, US
Thesis: *The development of the gender stereotypes about brilliance in Chinese young children*.
Advisor: Dr. Lin Bian
GPA: 4.0/4.0

2019 **B.S. in Psychology**
Department of Psychology, Beijing Normal University (BNU), Beijing, China
Honor Thesis: *Young children use different front-back clues to code locations in intrinsic reference.*
Advisor: Dr. Qingfen Hu
Major GPA: 3.92/4.0

SELECTED HONORS, AWARDS, GRANTS AND FELLOWSHIPS

2025 **Student and Early Career Council Dissertation Research Funding Award**, Society for Research in Child Development (SRCD, $2000)

2025 **Top 10 Poster Presentation**, Huskey Graduate Research Exhibition, University of Virginia

2025 **Grad Thesis SLAM Competition Finalist (Three Minute Thesis Competition)**, University of Virginia
- See more: *How Inequality Shapes Children's Trust*

2025 **Department Travel Grant**, University of Virginia ($500)

2025 **Student and Early Career Council Poster Competition Winner**, Society for Research in Child Development (SRCD)

2025 **Graduate Student Travel Award**, Society for Research in Child Development (SRCD, $300)

2024 **Department Travel Grant**, University of Virginia ($500)

2023 **Graduate Student Travel Award**, Society for Research in Child Development (SRCD, $300)

2023 **Student Grant Competition**, Association for Psychological Science (APS, $500)

Grant Title: *The Impact of Inequality on Young Children's Prosocial Behaviors*

2022 **Department Travel Grant**, University of Virginia ($500)

2019 **Conference Grant**, Cornell University Conference Grant ($500)

2019 **Excellent Senior Honor Thesis**, Beijing Normal University (top 5%)

2017-18 **Second Prize of Outstanding Undergraduate Scholarship**, Beijing Normal University

2017 **National Undergraduate Science and Technology Innovation Project Grant,** Beijing Normal University ($3000, top 5%)

2016 **First Prize of Outstanding Undergraduate Scholarship**, Beijing Normal University

PUBLICATIONS

* Indicates shared first authorship

1. **Shu., Y.**, & Vaish, A. (in press). The impact of inequality on children's prosocial behavior: The critical role of perceived unfairness. *Developmental Psychology*.
2. *Hu, Y., ***Shu, Y.**, & Zhao, X. (2026). Children consider changes in performance over time when reasoning about academic achievements. *npj Science of Learning*. *11*(1), 13. https://doi.org/10.1038/s41539-026-00401-1
3. **Shu, Y.**, Li, H. (Jessica), Ma, S., & Bian, L. (2024). The impact of sufferers' wealth status on pain perceptions: Its development and relation to allocation of healthcare resources. *Developmental Science*, *27*, e13467. https://doi.org/10.1111/desc.13467
4. **Shu, Y**., Hu, Q., Xu, F., & Bian, L. (2022). Gender stereotypes are racialized: A cross-cultural investigation of gender stereotypes about intellectual talents. *Developmental Psychology*, *58*(7), 1345–1359. https://doi.org/10.1037/dev0001356
   - See more: UChicago News

Book chapters

1. Vaish, A., **& Shu., Y.** (2026). The emotional foundations of human prosociality. *Advances in Child Development and Behavior*. http://10.1016/bs.acdb.2026.07.004

MANUSCRIPTS IN PREPARATION

+Indicates undergraduate students under supervision

Journal articles

1. **Shu, Y.**, Bernard, C., Chajes, J., Grossmann, T., & Vaish, A. (under review). Not so fast: Children's fair behavior may require deliberation and development.
2. **Shu, Y.**, & Vaish, A. (in preparation). Interpersonal inequality erodes social trust in early childhood.
3. Ma, S., **Shu, Y.**, & Vaish, A. (in preparation). Children consider transgression frequencies and apology quality in forgiving others.
4. **Shu, Y.**, Beeler-Duden, S., +Lambidakis, P., & Vaish, A. (in preparation). Children and parents' interpretations of others' prosocial behavior.
5. **Shu, Y.**, & Vaish, A. (in preparation). The justifiability of inequality shapes children's trust.
6. Ma, S., **Shu, Y.**, & Vaish, A. (in preparation). An efficiency model explaining the development of social preferences.
7. **Shu, Y**., +Soong, C., Wu, Y., Zhao, X., & Vaish, A. (in preparation). American and Chinese children's intuitive beliefs about leaders.
8. **Shu, Y.**, & Bian, L. (in preparation). Gender stereotypes in children's attribution of others' school performance.

9. **Shu, Y.**, & Bian, L. (in preparation). Young children's context-sensitive understanding of identity.

ONGOING PROJECTS

1. Ma, S., **Shu, Y.**, & Vaish, A. (Data collection completed). Computerized human images for learning and development.
2. **Shu, Y.**, +Liang, Y., & Vaish, A. (Data collection ongoing). The role of perceived justice in children's prosocial behavior.

CONFERENCE ORAL TALKS

1. **Shu, Y.**, & Vaish, A. (2026, April). *Seeds of mistrust: How inequality shapes children's trust and prosociality*. [Paper presentation] The Biennial Meeting of the Cognitive Developmental Society (CDS), Montreal, Canada.
2. **Shu, Y.**, & Vaish, A. (2026, Feb). *Seeds of mistrust: How inequality shapes children's trust and prosociality*. [Paper presentation] Trust and Cooperation Preconference, Annual Convention of the Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP), Virtual.
3. **Shu, Y.**, & Vaish, A. (2025, May). *The impact of inequality on children's trust and prosociality*. [Paper presentation] Association for Psychological Science Annual Convention (APS), Washington, D.C.
4. **Shu, Y.**, & Bian, L. (2025, May). *How do children make sense of boys' and girls' school performance?* [Symposium] The Biennial Meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development (SRCD), Minneapolis, MN.
5. **Shu, Y.**, & Vaish, A. (2024, Jun). *The impact of the experience of inequality on children's prosocial behaviors*. [Paper presentation] Jean Piaget Society (JPS), Toronto, Canada.
6. **Shu, Y.**, & Vaish, A. (2024, April). *The impact of the experience of inequality on children's prosocial behaviors*. [Paper presentation] The Diversifying Scholarship Research Conference, Virtual.
7. Zhao, X., Li D., Li, Z., & **Shu, Y.** (2024, March). *The development of socially mindful behaviors in early childhood*. [Symposium] The Biennial Meeting of the Cognitive Developmental Society (CDS), Pasadena, CA.
8. **Shu, Y.**, Lazaro, V., Li, H., & Bian, L. (2023, March). *Children gradually perceive the poor as experiencing more pain: evidence from the U.S. and China*. [Symposium] The Biennial Meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development (SRCD), Salt Lake City, UT.
9. **Shu, Y.**, Hu, Q., Xu, F., & Bian, L. (2021, April). *Who is smart? Investigating Chinese children's stereotypes about brilliance*. [Symposium] The Biennial Meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development (SRCD), Virtual.
10. Zhao, X., Yang, X., & **Shu, Y.** (2021, April). *Children consider constraints and past performance in their intuitive theories of academic achievement*. [Symposium] The Biennial Meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development (SRCD), Virtual.
11. Tuttle, L.M., Huisi, L., **Shu, Y.**, & Bian, L. (2021, April). *The influence of socioeconomic status on children's perceptions of others' pain and resource allocations*. [Symposium] The Biennial Meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development (SRCD), Virtual.

CONFERENCE POSTER PRESENTATION

1. Bernard, C., **Shu, Y.**, & Vaish, A. (2026, April). *Timing fairness: How decision speed shapes children's fairness choices*. The Biennial Meeting of the Cognitive Developmental Society (CDS), Montreal, Canada.
2. **Shu, Y.**, & Vaish, A. (2025, May). *The impact of inequality on children's trust and prosociality.* The Biennial Meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development (SRCD), Minneapolis, MN.

- **SRCD SECC Poster Competition Winner**

3. **Shu, Y.**, & Vaish, A. (2024, March). *The impact of the experience of inequality on children's prosocial behaviors*. The Biennial Meeting of the Cognitive Developmental Society (CDS), Pasadena, CA.
4. Clayton, S., Ma, S., **Shu, Y.**, & Vaish, A. (2024, March). *Boundaries of early forgiveness: the impact of apology type and transgression frequency on children's forgiveness decisions*. The Biennial Meeting of the Cognitive Developmental Society (CDS), Pasadena, CA.
5. Hu, Y., **Shu, Y.**, & Zhao, X. (2024, March). *Children consider changes in performance over time when reasoning about academic achievements*. The Biennial Meeting of the Cognitive Developmental Society (CDS), Pasadena, CA.
6. **Shu, Y.** & Vaish, A. (2023, March). *The impact of the experience of inequality on children's prosocial behaviors*. The Biennial Meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development (SRCD), Salt Lake City, UT.
7. Hu, Y., **Shu, Y.**, & Zhao, X. (2023, March). *Children consider changes in performance over time when reasoning about academic achievements*. The Biennial Meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development (SRCD), Salt Lake City, UT.
8. **Shu, Y.** & Bian, L. (2022, April). *Young children's context-sensitive understanding of identity*. The Biennial Meeting of the Cognitive Developmental Society (CDS), Madison, WI.
9. Lazaro, V., **Shu, Y.**, Li, H., & Bian, L. (2022, April). *Children's considerations of wealth status in perceiving others' physical and psychological pain*. The Biennial Meeting of the Cognitive Developmental Society (CDS), Madison, WI.
10. **Shu, Y.**, & Bian, L. (2021, February). *How do children make sense of boys' and girls' school performance?* The Preconference of the Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP), Virtual.
11. Bian, L., **Shu, Y.**, Hu, Q., & Xu, F. (2019, September). *The development of the gender stereotypes about brilliance in Chinese young children*. The Biennial Meeting of the Cognitive Developmental Society (CDS), Louisville, KY

OTHER TALKS AND PRESENTATIONS

2026/06 SRCD Science Programs Research Showcase Webinar, Virtual
2026/04 UVA Developmental Lunch Series, Fifth-year Talk, Charlottesville, VA
2026/02 University of California San Diego, Social Cognitive Development Lab, Invited talk, Virtual
2026/02 Boston College, Cooperation Lab, Invited talk, Virtual
2025/12 SDTIC Symposium: Reasoning about Fairness and Equity in Childhood, Junior Presentation, Virtual
2024/04 UVA Developmental Lunch Series, Third-year Talk, Charlottesville, VA
2024/01 UVA Developmental Lunch Series, Flash Talk, Charlottesville, VA
2023/01 UVA Developmental Lunch Series, Flash Talk, Charlottesville, VA
2022/05 UVA Developmental Lunch Series, First-year Talk, Charlottesville, VA
2021/04 East China Normal University, Culture and Child Development Lab, Invited talk, Shanghai, China

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Guest Lectures

2025/03 Moral Development, Introduction to Child Psychology at UVA
2024/08 Moral Development, Introduction to Child Psychology at UVA
2022/11 Moral Development, Introduction to Child Psychology at UVA

Teaching Assistantship

Lecture TA:

2026 Spring RM (Research Methods): R Application in Psychology, UVA
2025 Spring RM (Research Methods): Developmental Psychology, UVA
2024 Fall RM (Research Methods): R Application in Psychology, UVA
2023 Fall RM (Research Methods): R Application in Psychology, UVA
2023 Spring Psychology of Women and Gender, UVA
2022 Fall Introduction to Social Psychology, UVA
2022 Spring Introduction to Child Psychology, UVA
2018-2019 Studies that Changed Psychology, BNU

Lab TA:

2025 Fall Research Methods and Data Analysis II, UVA
2021 Fall Research Methods and Data Analysis II, UVA

SERVICE AND ACTIVITIES

2025/02 **Panelist**, UVA Psychology Dept, Psychology Outreach Program
2024-2025 **Graduate Subcommittee,** UVA Psychology Dept, DEI Rising Stars Subcommittee
2024-2025 **Committee**, UVA Diversifying Scholarship Conference
2023-24 **Coordinator**, UVA Psychology Dept, Child Development Labs
2023/03 **Presenter**, UVA Psychology Dept, Psychology Outreach Program
2022-2025 **Student Area Representative**, UVA Psychology Dept, Psychology Committees
2021-2025 **Graduate Research Assistant**, UVA Living Lab
2016-17 **Division President**, BNU Psychology Dept, Student Union

MENTORSHIP [+MENTEE AWARDS & HONORS]

Honors Study Students at UVA

Yufan Liang 2024-2026, incoming Ph.D. student at the University of Minnesota
- 2026: Highest Distinction in the Department of Psychology, UVA
- 2025: Harrison Undergraduate Research Award, UVA ($5000)

  Project Title: *Inequality and Risk-Taking Behavior in Children*

Caleb Soong 2023-2025, currently the Lab Manager at Indiana University Bloomington, working with Dr. Elizabeth Gunderson
- 2025: Research Excellence in Department of Psychology, UVA
- 2025: Highest Distinction in the Department of Psychology, UVA

Paul Lambidakis 2023-2025
- 2025: Research Excellence in the Department of Psychology, UVA
- 2025: Highest Distinction in the Department of Psychology, UVA

Undergraduate Research Assistants

Irene Chen 2025-present, UVA
Ruiyang Liu 2025-present, UVA
Siyue He 2024-2026, UVA
Ridhi Pendyala 2024-2026, UVA
Katherine Tang 2023-2026, UVA
Chandler Tribble 2024-2025, UVA
Ashley Stage 2023-2024, UVA
Georgia Beatty 2023-2024, UVA
Madeleine Nguyen 2023-2024, UVA

Rosa Masharipova	2022-2024, UVA
Olivia Braye	2023, UVA
Katlin Blakeslee	2022-2023, UVA
Charlotte Milone	2022-2023, UVA
Beverly Lundeen	2022, UVA
Wenjing Zhang	2022, UVA
Ruoheng (Rose) Sha	2023, Boston University
Rulan Zhang	2022-2023, University of Chicago
Lin Lin	2019-2020, Cornell University

- 2020: Undergraduate Research Program Summer Stipend, Cornell University ($4000)

Chunlu Li	2019-2020, Cornell University
Melissa Yanez	2019-2020, Cornell University
Betty Bai	2019-2020, Cornell University

High School Students

Annie Zhu	2022-2023, currently Undergraduate Student in Psychology Dept at Cornell University

SKILLS

- **Programming:** R(advanced), SPSS (advanced), Python (proficient)
- **Assessment**: Qualtrics (advanced), jsPsych (basic)
- **Design & Editing**: Adobe Photoshop (advanced), HitFilm Express (advanced), CapCut (advanced)
- **Language**: Mandarin (native), English (fluent)

REFERENCES

Amrisha Vaish, Ph.D.
Associate Professor of Psychology
University of Virginia
Email: av8u@virginia.edu

Lin Bian, Ph.D.
Associate Professor of Psychology
University of Chicago
Email: linbian@uchicago.edu

Xin (Alice) Zhao, Ph.D.
Associate Professor of Educational Psychology
East China Normal University
Email: xzhao@dep.ecnu.edu.cn

Jazmin L. Brown-Iannuzzi, Ph.D.
Associate Professor of Psychology
University of Virginia
Email: jb3jd@virginia.edu

Michael Meyer, Ph.D.
Associate Professor of Psychology
University of Virginia
Email: mjm9ff@virginia.edu